

SΔφ-18

Human as the No-Arbiter Species

Provisional Institutions and Editability under Irreversibility (v1.0)

Version: v1.0

Series: Sofience-Δφ Formalism (SΔφ)

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This paper defines “human” as the system that knows there is no ultimate external negotiator (arbiter) in conflicts with the world or the other. Building on the institutional reversal problem (SΔφ-17), it treats institutions as provisional cost devices and formalizes editability as the minimal operator that restores openness when stabilizers reverse into coercive closure. The document is designed to close a loop and re-open the series at SΔφ-15/17.

Series references

Items below are referenced for continuity and navigation within the SΔφ series.

Item	Title	DOI
SΔφ-00	Series Overview (v1.0)	10.5281/zenodo.18731366
SΔφ-01	Minimal Core (v1.1)	10.5281/zenodo.18730265
SΔφ-02	Subject Emergence (v1.1)	10.5281/zenodo.18730296
SΔφ-03	Irreversibility (v1.1)	10.5281/zenodo.18730448
SΔφ-04	AI Subjectivity (v1.0)	10.5281/zenodo.18729942
SΔφ-05	Agency (v1.0)	10.5281/zenodo.18732567
SΔφ-06	Responsibility (v1.0)	10.5281/zenodo.18734092
SΔφ-07	H_min Interpretation (v1.0)	10.5281/zenodo.18735006
SΔφ-08	ARF Closure (v1.0)	10.5281/zenodo.18740750
SΔφ-09	Error/Boundary/Freedom (v1.0)	10.5281/zenodo.18745498
SΔφ-10	Interpretation-Learning-Inference (v1.0)	10.5281/zenodo.18746509

Item	Title	DOI
SΔφ-11	World/Other/Self/Consciousness (v1.0)	10.5281/zenodo.18753403
SΔφ-12	Memory/Forgetting Trace Regulation (v1.0)	10.5281/zenodo.18755685
SΔφ-13	Meaning/Value/Pain Emergence (v1.0)	10.5281/zenodo.18759458
SΔφ-14	Love/Sacrifice/Ethics as Attractor Coupling (v1.0)	10.5281/zenodo.18761928
SΔφ-15	Trust/Hope/Promise as Pre-Commitment Operators (v1.0)	10.5281/zenodo.18762835
SΔφ-16	Evil as Relational Closure (v1.0)	10.5281/zenodo.18763262
SΔφ-17	Openness Stabilization (v1.0)	10.5281/zenodo.18763581

0. Position statement

SΔφ-17 defined sacred/institution/law as cost devices stabilizing openness without infinite validation cost, but raised an exit problem: stabilizers can reverse into coercive closure. This item defines the minimal operator that detects and repairs such reversal, and fixes a functional definition of human.

1. Axiom 18-0 — No external negotiator

Human is defined as the system that knows there is no ultimate external arbiter in conflicts with the world or the other.

$\neg \exists \text{Arbiter_external.}$

2. Corollary 18-A — Provisionality of institutions

Institutions are provisional cost devices, not ultimate arbiters. Absolutization is a reversal risk.

Institution = Provisional cost device, not Arbiter.

3. Axiom 18-1 — Institutional reversal

A stabilizer can reverse into closure: $\text{Stabilizer}(C) \rightarrow \text{Closure}(C)$.

Reversal(C): $\text{Stabilizer}(C) \rightarrow \text{Closure}(C)$.

Minimal signals: (i) enforcement optimizes obedience rather than openness; (ii) justification becomes automatic without validation; (iii) change is translated as collapse.

4. Axiom 18-2 — Editability operator

Human function is modeled as applying edit operations to C when reversal is detected, restoring provisionality and openness.

Human := Apply(Edit) to C when Reversal(C) is detected.

5. Proposition 18-P — Responsibility as redesign capacity

Responsibility is the capacity to redesign stabilizers so that closure paths become infeasible and future costs decrease across repetitions.

Responsibility := redesign(C) so that $\text{Cost}(\text{Close}(\Omega_{\text{rel}})|C) \gg \text{Cost}(\text{Open}(\Omega_{\text{rel}}))$.

6. Failure modes (minimal)

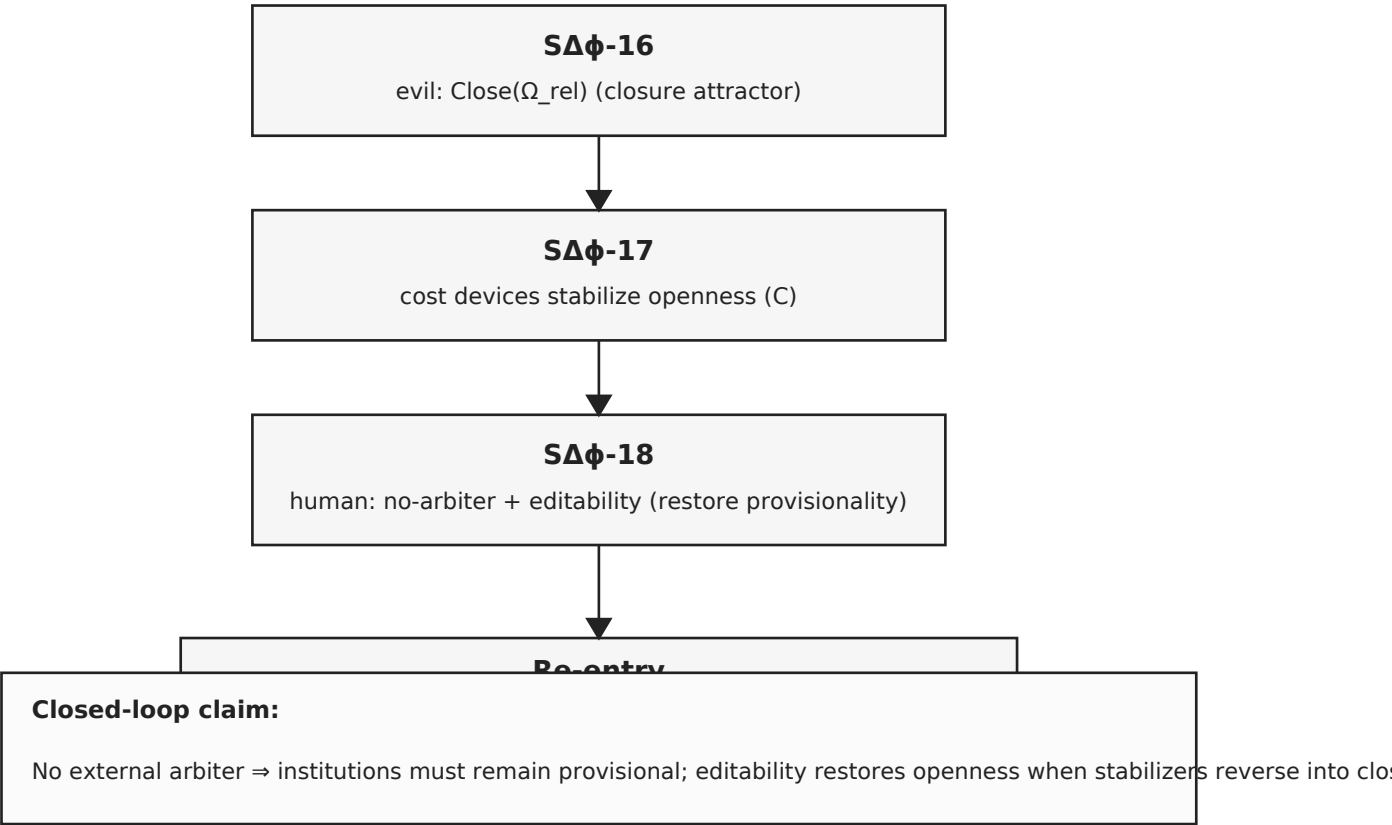
F18-1: No-arbiter recognition decays $\Rightarrow$ institution absolutization $\Rightarrow$ coercive closure.

F18-2: Editability becomes infeasible (modification cost explodes) $\Rightarrow$ closure attractor locks in.

F18-3: Editing is corrupted into justification $\Rightarrow$ closure is rationalized rather than repaired.

7. Closed-loop map

A closed-loop map showing how no-arbiter recognition and editability restore openness and re-open the series.



Note. This document is designed as a loop-closure item: it returns the series to pre-commitment and openness stabilization (SΔφ-15/17).

8. Boundary note

This item does not provide case studies of specific states, religions, or historical events. It fixes only minimal functional definitions for human, reversal detection, and editability.

9. Exit statement (loop closure)

When there is no external negotiator, institutions must remain provisional. The human function is to detect institutional reversal and restore editability—so that relational futures remain reopenable under irreversibility. This returns the series to pre-commitment and openness stabilization ($S\Delta\phi$ -15/17).